

Philipp Hilbert. *Protocol Product Manager, DeFi infrastructure.*

Positioning, ten years shipping technical products in regulated and complex environments, now focused on open credit infrastructure at the protocol layer.

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§ WHY MORPHO

Morpho is doing something structurally interesting: separating the primitive from the product, so that the protocol itself becomes credibly neutral infrastructure that anyone can build on. The description of managing tradeoffs between extending the protocol, improving surrounding infrastructure, and enabling partners is exactly the kind of product surface where clear thinking about sequencing matters most. The part that stands out is the requirement to "evaluate when to deliberately avoid adding complexity", that is a harder discipline than shipping features, and it is where protocol products either stay composable or quietly become monoliths. *That constraint is where product judgment earns its keep.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, code review and synthesis
- **Cursor**, context-aware development
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes
- **GPT**, research and adversarial review
- **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Django, SQL, OpenShift, CI/CD pipelines, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CRYPTO BACKTESTING ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

A personal infrastructure for systematic strategy research across on-chain and centralized venues.

- Ingests trade history and order book snapshots from Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch to build a unified execution record.
 - Built around a file-queue-based agent loop for parallel hypothesis evaluation, keeping research and execution cleanly separated.
 - Tracks slippage, price impact, and routing quality as first-class metrics alongside P&L, drawing on Coinglass and Hyblock Capital analytics.
 - Directly relevant to building discovery infrastructure for protocol health metrics: the same discipline of defining measurable signals before you act applies equally to trading and to product iteration.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MORPHO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the release process end-to-end, map existing curator and integrator workflows by reading support tickets and existing specs, and identify where the current roadmap rationale is implicit rather than written down.

WEEK 2

Run first discovery.

Schedule structured conversations with two or three active curators or distributors to surface the friction points that do not appear in the backlog, and bring back a first synthesis to the protocol team for a sanity check.

Sequence, commit, ship.

Pick one initiative that is both near-term executable and clearly tied to a measurable outcome, write the requirements, agree the success criteria with engineering and research, and drive it through to launch.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Morpho team,

I have been following Morpho's architecture for some time, specifically the design decision to separate the base protocol from the product layer and let external curators and distributors own the risk/reward configuration. That is a structurally different bet from most DeFi lending protocols, and it is the right one if the goal is credibly neutral infrastructure that institutional participants can build on without depending on the protocol team's governance cadence. The role you are hiring for sits at the centre of that bet: keeping the protocol lean, composable, and correctly sequenced while the ecosystem around it grows faster than any single team can directly manage.

My background is in technically complex, regulated, cross-functional environments where the product manager is the person who keeps a distributed group of engineers, researchers, and external stakeholders moving toward the same outcome. At Rohde & Schwarz I ran a cross-functional team of 15 engineers and data scientists building an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, shipping a GitOps-based rollout that cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable without a change-freeze window. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I carried a full UI relaunch, a container migration, and an ETL overhaul through the same cycle by being explicit about sequencing and making the dependencies visible before committing to dates. Both situations required reasoning about system constraints and communicating tradeoffs to non-technical stakeholders without losing the technical detail that engineers need to act confidently.

On the crypto and DeFi side: I have been an active participant for eight years, trading and managing assets across centralised and decentralised venues including Hyperliquid, Jupiter, 1inch, and Across Protocol. I work with perpetual futures, DEX aggregation, cross-chain bridging, and liquidation analytics as a practitioner, not an observer. I have built a personal backtesting engine to study execution quality, slippage, price impact, routing, and I spend time on market microstructure and protocol mechanics. My interest is in the infrastructure layer: stablecoins, custody, exchange connectivity, and the systems that make digital asset markets function at scale. That is the same layer Morpho operates on, and it means I can have the curator and integrator conversations you need without needing a DeFi orientation period.

The specific ask in your success criteria, to have shipped a meaningful protocol improvement and show how it advanced user or business outcomes within six months, is one I am comfortable committing to. I work best when success is defined in advance, because it forces a discipline of choosing the right problem before the right solution. At CLINET Platforms I cut a backlog that a five-person team could not deliver to the top 10% of features against agreed measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold. That trade-off calculus, what to drop so that what remains actually lands, is exactly what the protocol roadmap role requires.

I am in Berlin, well inside your GMT+2 timezone window, available at short notice, and genuinely motivated by what Morpho is building. I would welcome a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of ownership across regulated and technically complex environments, defence AI, public-sector data platforms, insurance SaaS, fintech, and healthcare. Combines strong technical fluency (DevOps, data pipelines, distributed systems) with continuous discovery practice and cross-functional delivery leadership. Now focused on protocol-layer infrastructure in DeFi, where composability, sequencing discipline, and measurable outcomes matter more than feature throughput.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

DeFi and crypto: CEX/DEX mechanics, AMMs, perpetuals, MEV, bridges, oracles, liquidation analytics, on-chain execution, 8+ years as active practitioner

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, ART, PI planning

SDLC and Delivery: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, containerised environments, branching strategy, release gating, regression and end-to-end test automation

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop

facilitation, async communication, conflict resolution

Analytics and data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Python, Kotlin, Django, REST APIs, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning, fintech regulatory exposure

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps rollout (ArgoCD) cut deployment from days to 30 minutes; 200% increase in pipeline runs by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design; led 15-person cross-functional team for the FCAS European programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data update time by 75%; integrated test automation into Jenkins pipeline; carried full UI relaunch and container migration concurrently. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success criteria; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS interface cutting digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition dropped to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy B2B procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

WiFi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model; LLM agents across the funnel; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-resistant encryption product installable in under two minutes; later Chair of the Board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments from zero through acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem. Fintech, payments, and crypto infrastructure experience from first principles.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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